



Kodak Moments chatbot

Chatbot from Kodak uses machine learning to suggest best photos from your Facebook for printing <http://digit.in/KodakBot>



Tesla-mart?

Tesla is considering adding small convenience stores to charging stations for you to relax and stock up while your car charges. <http://digit.in/TeslaMart>

Samsung Galaxy Note 8

Back with a bang (hopefully not!)

Samsung's Galaxy Note has always been its prized product. It's a category Samsung created, and the Galaxy Note 8 is poised to spoil Apple's tri-phone party. For the most part, this is an S8 Plus with the S-Pen, but then again, in many ways it isn't.

Camera

It's no surprise that Samsung chose the telephoto+wide angle offering for the Note 8, but OIS on both rear cameras does make this enticing. It shoots bright low light photos, vibrant colours and produces soft details often. But, the Note 8 is markedly different too, since it does all this with greater detail and better colour definition. In a way, the Note 8 proves that the second sensor is what Samsung's cameras were missing so far.

On the Galaxy Note 8, optical zooming is seamless. Samsung has the 1x-2x button on the viewfinder, and the cameras interchange without any lags or hitches. It's also a decently detailed photo, though it's not the optimum quality this phone is capable of. Like the iPhone, the Galaxy Note 8 allows you to run up to 10x zoom, but anything beyond 2x is done digitally and it's not really useful.

S-Pen

The company has added some features to the S-Pen this time, that can be considered more enthusiast friendly, than business-like. Samsung now has handwritten GIFs that can be shared on any platform supporting GIFs.

Then there are GIFs from videos that lets you cut out GIFs from any video playing on the phone.

Translate is a new feature with the Note 8. It works with almost all text that is on the phone's screen, although



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VALUE.....	70
DESIGN.....	95

we did have trouble translating text in photos sometimes.

Taking notes works like it always did. But, on the Note 8, you can also start writing on the Always On display and Samsung allows over 100 pages of notes on this.

Build and Design

We dropped the Note 8 by mistake, from about three feet and it didn't break. Samsung has used tough glass on the Note 8 and you'll probably get away with the simpler drops, or if you can break the fall somehow.

The company struck gold with its curved display a few years ago, and has been milking it since. The Note 8 has a sharper and more block-like design than the S8+, which feels more ergonomic to us. It's also substantially heavier than the S8. From a design purview, we're truly fond of the Note 8.

Display

Samsung's Infinity Display makes an appearance on the Note 8, and it's as great as it was on the Galaxy S8. You

get extremely deep black thanks to the OLED panel, while overall contrast levels are great too. Colour tones are warmer than natural, but we know many who would prefer this to an iPhone's more true to source tones.

Performance

The company has tweaked Touchwiz to make it smoother, lighter and better looking, but as a rule of thumb, Android phones do slow down with time. We were using the Galaxy S8 Plus for four months before switching to the Note 8, and that phone is noticeably slower than it was out of the box.

When you first use the Note 8, it's amongst the fastest phones on the market today. It has oodles of RAM and one of the fastest processors there is today. It breaks benchmark scores of course, and in the past week, we've seen no lags or stutters on it. Rather, they weren't any greater than what you would already expect from an Android phone.

Battery

Samsung put a slightly smaller battery on the Note 8, than that on the Galaxy S8 Plus. The 3300 mAh battery isn't exemplary but it beat our expectations. With 100% battery at 9 am, the phone would creep into the battery red zone at around 8-8.30pm every day. The PC Mark Work 2.0 battery test lasts for 9 hours and 58 minutes.

Verdict

The Samsung Galaxy Note 8 is premium to the core and the S-Pen is available only on this device. The fact is that the OnePlus 5 still does feel faster than this phone, though the camera on this phone is indeed much better, especially in low light conditions.

—Prasid Banerjee

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Exynos 8895 | GPU: Mali-G71 | OS: Android 7.1.1 (Nougat) | CARD SLOT: microSD, up to 256 GB | DISPLAY TYPE: Super AMOLED | SIZE: 6.3 inches | RESOLUTION: 1440 x 2960 pixels | CAMERA PRIMARY: Dual 12 MP, f/1.7 & f/2.4, OIS, 2x Optical Zoom | CAMERA SECONDARY: 8 MP, f/1.7, 1.2µm pixel size.

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